

The Second Cleft

Session 002 — A Shadowdale Adventure

Title	The Second Cleft
Tier / Level	Tier 2 — 5 PCs at Level 5 (advance to 6 on completion)
Duration	~3.5–4 hours of play
Setting	Shadowdale → Old Skull's northern flank → the Living Wood fringe
Hook From	Session 001 — The Missing Scout (the Vhaeraunian map fragment)

Adventure Summary

The Vhaeraunian map fragment the party recovered last session is no longer just intelligence — it's a deadline. Lady Ulphor confirms her militia have corroborated the markings: the two unscouted sites are real, and the southern one (Site B, in the Living Wood) has gone dark in the last forty-eight hours. The party is dispatched to scout Site B for evidence of where the cell went, then proceed to Site C — the deeper cave on the northern flank — and either neutralize it or bring back enough information for Lady Ulphor to commit the militia to a coordinated strike.

Site B turns out to have been purged the night before by a rival drow faction. Site C is a half-finished Vhaeraunian shrine-camp, run by a priest of Vhaeraun named **Khelziir Aun'velve**, racing to consecrate a small surface-side portal anchor. **Zeldrazz T'orrl is here** — alive, healed, demoted, and furious. The session ends with the portal anchor either smashed, stolen for study, or — if the party is clever and lucky — turned into a Harper intelligence asset.

Scene 1 — The Briefing at the Ashaba House

Setup

Morning. Lady Addee Ulphor's working room at the Ashaba House. **Brynn Ashford** is present and taking notes; **Corwick Helm** arrives partway through, leather apron still on. Lady Ulphor has the Vhaeraunian map fragment unrolled on her desk, weighted with a tin mug and an inkwell.



Brynn Ashford — Shadowdale's Delegate to the Dales Council



Corwick Helm — Blacksmith and Militia Captain

What Lady Ulphor Offers

- **250 gp** on completion of the scouting mission, with proof
- **+200 gp bonus** if the party can disable or destroy any drow staging site

- Sela Wyndmere's herbal kit — 3× healing poultices, 2× antitoxin (already paid for)
- The use of two militia at the trailhead as reserve: **Aelinor Wains** (Corwick's most reliable scout) and, if the party insists, **Rellan Tessar** — Corwick prefers Aelinor; Rellan is still Exhaustion 1

New Information Lady Ulphor Shares

- **Site B** (southern marking, Living Wood) was watched by a militia scout for two days. As of yesterday morning, smoke from the chimney *stopped*. Either the cell broke camp or something killed them.
- **Site C** (northern marking, deeper in Old Skull's flank) is showing increased activity. Sela has reported fey withdrawing from a quarter-mile radius around it.
- The map fragment had a sigil in the corner the party didn't recognize. Lady Ulphor has identified it: a **Vhaeraunian priestly mark**. A *cleric* is on the surface. That changes the threat profile.

Side Channel — Brynn Ashford

Brynn will, at some point during the briefing or after, find a moment to speak privately with one PC (GM's choice — likely the one with the highest CHA or already known to be politically aware). His ask: **Orvyn Tal asked him this morning whether the militia were planning to follow up on the map**. Brynn lied and said no. He'd like to know what the party finds before the Harpers do.

DM Notes — Briefing Tone

- Lady Ulphor is composed but tighter than last session. She touches the Pendant of Ashaba twice while talking.
- Corwick volunteers Aelinor over Rellan with no explanation; the truth is he doesn't trust Rellan's nerves yet.
- If the party asks about Captain Helm's earlier cover-up, Lady Ulphor says simply: "*Captain Helm and I are speaking later this week. The matter is closed publicly. Privately it remains open.*"

Scene 2 — The Living Wood Approach (Site B)



The Hawthorn Chimney — Site B Approach

Travel

Approximately 5 hours from the village to the southern site, on Old Skull's southwestern flank, through the fey-dense edge of the Living Wood. Aelinor (and Rellan, if he came) holds the trailhead at a half-collapsed shepherd's bothy ~30

minutes from Site B. Beyond that, the party is on its own.

Skill Challenge — "The Wood is Watching"

4 successes before 3 failures. DCs 13–15. Suggested checks (one per PC per round, no repeats):

- **Survival** or **Nature** to find Sela's old foraging trail
- **Perception** or **Investigation** to spot fey wards on bark — acorn-and-iron warnings to trespassers
- **Persuasion** or **Performance** to greet a watching dryad respectfully (Nalith and Fiorn shine here)
- **Arcana** to recognize a flickering Feywild seam and route around it

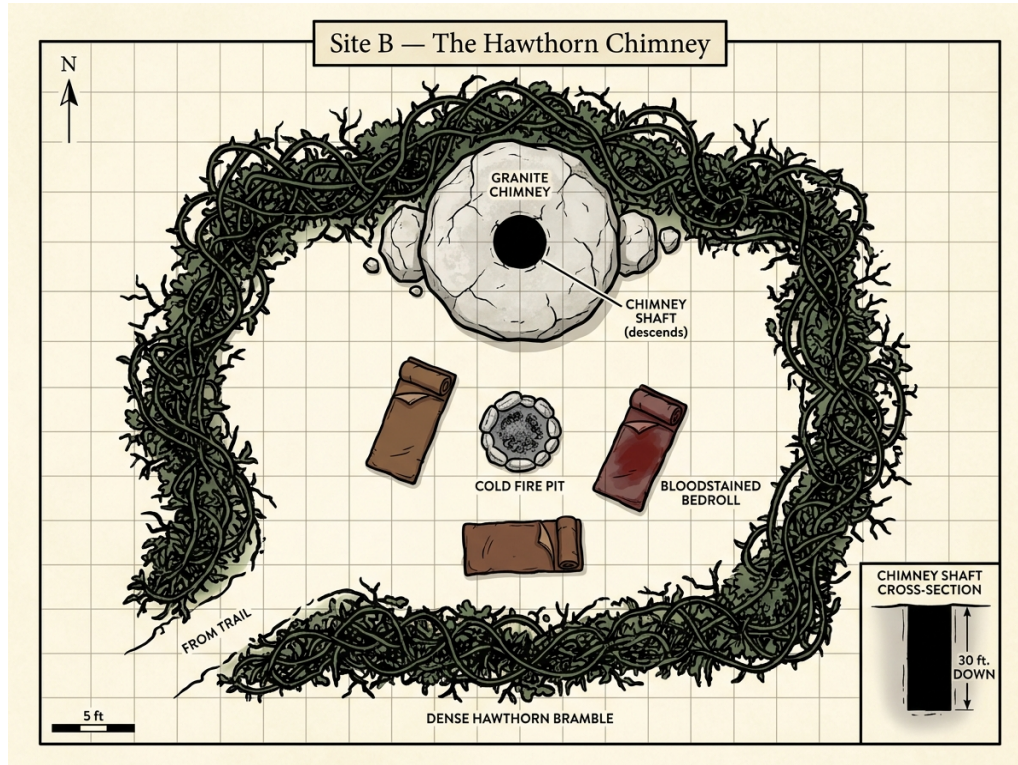
Outcomes:

- **Per failure:** a glamour-trick costs the party an hour, splits the marching order, or imposes one level of Exhaustion on the failing PC until next short rest.
- **On full success:** they arrive at Site B in late afternoon, with daylight still to work in.
- **On full failure:** they arrive at dusk, having lost their reserve at the bothy (Aelinor will hold but won't be able to find them again), and the encounter inside Site B happens in dim light.

Arrival at Site B

Approaching the Hawthorn Chimney

The hawthorn closes overhead in a low arch — pale berries, black thorns. Beneath the boughs, a fire pit lies cold under a film of ash, three bedrolls splayed around it like petals torn from a flower. One has a long dark stain along its length. The chimney mouth is a dark wound in the rock, and from inside, very faintly, comes the sound of something dragging itself upward.



Tactical Map — Site B, The Hawthorn Chimney

What the Party Finds (DC 13 Investigation)

- A natural rock chimney rising 20 ft. into a granite outcrop, surrounded by hawthorn
- Fire pit cold for ~30 hours. Three bedrolls; one slashed open and bloodstained
- **Drag marks** — humanoid, leading *into* the chimney shaft and *down*
- A **bone scroll case** with a half-burnt Undercommon order: "...abandon Site B, reinforce the priest, the surface anchor must be set by the dark of the moon."
- A **Vhaeraun half-mask**, smaller than Zeldrazz's, ceremonial, broken
- A **spider-silk thread** leading down the chimney's interior — too thick to be natural

Encounter — What Came Up After

As soon as the party investigates the chimney shaft (or after ~3 in-fiction minutes if they hesitate), the wounded survivor of last night's purge climbs out to silence the witnesses.



The Wounded Drider — Lolthite Enforcer at Site B

Combatants

Combatant	CR	XP	Notes
Wounded Drider (Lolthite)	6	2,300	Below half HP at start; will fight to silence party
Giant Spider × 2	1	200 each	Climb out of the shaft on initiative count 10 of round 1

Tactics

- The drider opens with **Web** on the party's heaviest melee (most likely Kto), then closes with the obsidian dagger and bite. It uses the chimney shaft as a fallback — if reduced below 1/4 HP, it will attempt to retreat downward.

- The two giant spiders flank — one stays in the chimney shaft (advantage on attacks vs. anyone leaning in), the other drops onto the closest light-armored caster (Yinu or Loric).
- **Encounter difficulty:** Hard for 5×L5 (~2,700 XP). Adjust by adding a third spider for Deadly.

What This Means (DM-facing)

This is the first hard evidence that the **Vhaeraunian and Lolthite drow factions are at war beneath Shadowdale**. The drider is a Lolthite enforcer; the camp she purged was Vhaeraunian. The party can exploit this rivalry going forward — or get caught between it. The drider, if interrogated rather than killed (good luck), knows only that her matron was ordered to "*close the surface mouths Vhaeraun is opening.*" She will not cooperate willingly.

Loot from Site B

- **Bone scroll case** with the half-burnt Vhaeraunian order (intelligence — Lady Ulphor will pay 50 gp)
- **Broken ceremonial half-mask** (Orvyn Tal will pay 80 gp; Lady Ulphor 40 gp)
- **Drow poison ×2 vials** looted from the bedrolls (the spiders disturbed them but didn't take them)
- ~30 gp in mixed coin and trade goods

Scene 3 — Travel to Site C & The Watcher Above



The Cleft Mouth — Site C Entrance

The Trek

Approximately 4 hours overland from Site B to Site C, skirting the granite shoulder of Old Skull. If Aelinor and Rellan are with the party, they hold position at the shepherd's bothy — they will not enter the cleft regardless of how the conversation goes. Corwick was clear about that.

Encounter — The Watcher

A single **Drow Scout (CR 1/2)** is perched in a wind-stunted pine 60 ft. above the cleft mouth, with a brass signal horn slung at her belt. **DC 17 Perception** to spot her before she spots the party. If she sees them first, she **blows the horn before being killed** — Khelziir's cell goes to alert status, and the party loses surprise on the antechamber fight in Scene 4.

The Cleft Mouth

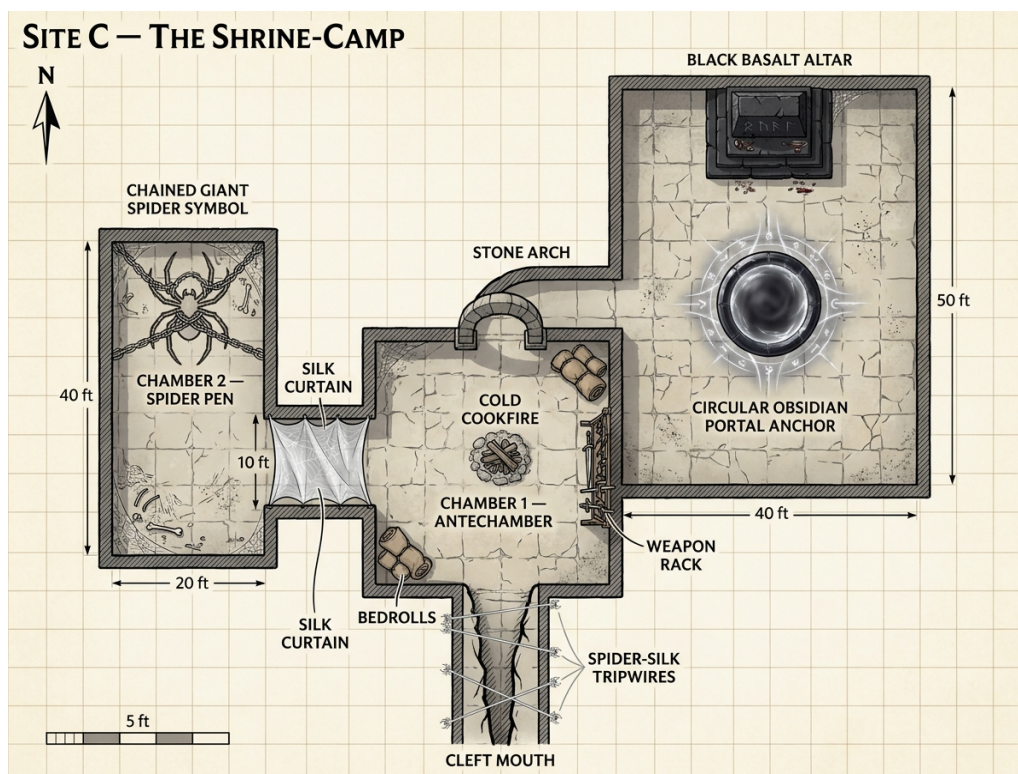
A vertical fissure 6 ft. wide, 10 ft. tall, breathing cold spider-musk air. Spider silk threads cross the opening at ankle and chest height — a tripwire warning system Khelziir installed last week. **DC 14 Perception** to spot the silk in the dim light at the cleft's lip. Anyone who walks into it without spotting it triggers a soft chime that echoes down the cleft — Chamber 1 goes to alert.

Approach Options

- **Frontal stealth** — Stealth check (group, DC 13) to enter the cleft without triggering the silk
- **Cut the wires** — Sleight of Hand (DC 12) to cut without ringing the chime
- **Climb above** — the cleft is climbable along a side chimney; DC 15 Athletics, drops party into Chamber 1 from the ceiling (no silk, surprise round if quiet)

Scene 4 — The Shrine-Camp (Site C)

A three-chamber dungeon carved into a natural cleft beneath Old Skull's northern face. The Vhaeraunians have been working here for roughly two weeks. Khelziir is in a hurry; the place is functional, not finished.



Tactical Map — Site C, The Shrine-Camp

Chamber 1 — The Antechamber

A 30 × 30 ft. natural cavern with two bedroll piles, a cold cookfire in the center, and a weapon rack against the east wall holding three hand crossbows and a sheaf of bolts. 2× **Drow Scouts** (CR 1/4) are on watch; one is fletching, one is dozing. If the party kept surprise, both can be dropped in the first round; if not, one will sprint for the Shrine to warn Khelziir.

Chamber 2 — The Spider Pen

A 20 × 40 ft. side chamber separated from Chamber 1 by a curtain of spider-silk. 1× **Giant Spider** (CR 1) is chained to the wall — Khelziir's pet sentinel. If the silk curtain is disturbed, the spider **shrieks** (a Vhaeraunian-trained alarm response), audible throughout the dungeon. Cutting the chain releases the spider; it will not distinguish friend from foe.

Chamber 3 — The Shrine



The Shrine Chamber — Site C Interior

A 40 × 50 ft. chamber. A black basalt slab altar at the back, draped with a Vhaeraunian half-mask banner. A **partially-consecrated portal anchor** sits at the chamber's center: a circle of obsidian shards 8 ft. across, half-inscribed with Undercommon glyphs in luminescent silver ink. Khelziir stands at the altar mid-ritual; Zeldrazz flanks him. Black candles burn on the altar with greenish flames.

The Boss Encounter



Khelziir Aun'velve — Drow Priest of Vhaeraun

Khelziir Aun'velve — Drow Priest of Vhaeraun

Medium humanoid (drow), neutral evil. CR 6. AC 16 (chain shirt + shield of faith). HP 78 (12d8+24). Speed 30 ft. STR 11, DEX 14, CON 14, INT 13, WIS 17, CHA 14. Saves WIS +6, CHA +5. Skills Perception +6, Religion +4, Stealth +5. Senses darkvision 120 ft., passive Perception 16. Languages Common, Elvish, Undercommon. **Innate Spellcasting:** faerie fire 1/day, darkness 1/day, levitate 1/day. **Spellcasting (cleric, save DC 14, +6 to hit):** cantrips — guidance, sacred flame, thaumaturgy; 1st (4) — bane, command, shield of faith; 2nd (3) — silence, spiritual weapon; 3rd (3) — dispel magic, spirit guardians; 4th (1) — banishment. **Sunlight Sensitivity.**

Actions

- **Multiattack:** Two shortsword attacks.
- **Shortsword:** +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., 1d6+2 piercing plus 1d6 poison.
- **Hand Crossbow:** +5 to hit, range 30/120 ft., 1d6+2 piercing plus drow poison (Save DC 13 CON or unconscious 1 hour, ends if damaged).

Tactics

Round 1: casts *spirit guardians* (shadow-form skull spirits orbit him), then bonus-action *shield of faith* on himself. **Round 2:** *silence* centered on the loudest caster (likely Yinu or Loric — shut down the Wizard or the Sorcerer). **Round 3:** *spiritual weapon* (a black blade) and continues the consecration ritual. **Round 4+:** if the anchor is still intact, it activates and summons reinforcements (see below). Khelziir will not break formation from the altar — finishing the ritual matters more than his own survival.



Zeldrazz T'orrl — Drow Elite Warrior, Demoted

Zeldrazz T'orrl — Returning Antagonist

Medium humanoid (drow), neutral evil. CR 5. Use the *Drow Elite Warrior* stat block (MM p.128). Reskinned with: a plain steel scimitar in place of the drow-made one; a fresh scar across his left cheek; a chip on his shoulder the size of Old Skull. He has personally targeted whichever PC dealt the killing-attempt blow last session and will **open with poisoned attacks against them.**

Encounter Math

Combatant	CR	XP
Khelziir Aun'velve (Vhaeraun priest)	6	2,300
Zeldrazz T'orrl (drow elite warrior)	5	1,800
Drow Scout × 2 (Antechamber)	1/4	100
Giant Spider (if released from pen)	1	200
Total (if all engaged)	—	~4,400 (Hard for 5×L5)

The Ritual Countdown

3 rounds remaining when the party enters the Shrine. Each round Khelziir is alive, conscious, and not silenced or stunned, the countdown ticks down by one. If it reaches zero, the portal anchor **activates**: a tear opens above the obsidian circle and **4× Vhaeraunian drow reinforcements** (use Drow stat block, MM p.128) step through on the next initiative. The encounter escalates to Deadly. The party can stop the countdown by: killing Khelziir, knocking him unconscious, silencing him for a full round (he can step out of *silence*, so this only delays), or destroying the half-finished anchor itself (**AC 12, 40 HP, vulnerable to bludgeoning** — but striking it provokes opportunity attacks from anyone in melee with the striker, and Khelziir treats it as an attack on himself).

The Three Endings

1) Smash the anchor (loud win) — The portal collapses inward in a thunderclap of cold air. Khelziir's cell is permanently shut down; Lady Ulphor is delighted; the militia get credit publicly; the Vhaeraunians know the surface knows. *Reputation: +Lady Ulphor, +Corwick. Loose end: a furious response from below within 2–3 weeks.*

2) Steal the anchor for study (quiet win) — Requires a successful **DC 16 Arcana** check by Yinu or Loric to disrupt the consecration without triggering the portal. The anchor goes back to Lady Ulphor, who hands it to Orvyn Tal for Harper analysis. *Reputation: +Harpers significantly, +Lady Ulphor privately, neutral publicly.*

3) Turn it into a feed (clever win) — If a PC succeeds on a **DC 18 Religion or Arcana** check after Khelziir falls, they realize the half-finished anchor can be left running as a one-way listening glyph into the Vhaeraunian command structure. Orvyn Tal will pay handsomely (**+500 gp**) and offer Harper recruitment for this. *Reputation: +Harpers heavily; the Vhaeraunians don't know they're being listened to — yet.*

NPCs in Play

NPC	Source	Role This Session
Lady Addee Ulphor	Roster	Briefing, payment, post-session debrief
Brynn Ashford	Roster	Side-channel ask about Harper disclosure
Corwick Helm	Roster	Militia liaison; assigns Aelinor
Sela Wyndmere	Roster	Provides poultices; fey-edge warning about Site C
Orvyn Tal	Roster	Surfaces post-session if anchor route 2 or 3 chosen
Rellan Tessar	Session 001	Wants to come; Corwick says no
Aelinor Wains	NEW (DM addition)	Militia scout; holds the trailhead — flag for canonization
Khelziir Aun'velve	NEW (DM addition)	Vhaeraunian priest antagonist — flag for canonization

NPC	Source	Role This Session
Zeldrazz T'orrl	Session 001	Returning antagonist (alive, demoted, furious)

Treasure & Rewards

- **250 gp** scouting payment + **200 gp bonus** for neutralizing Site C = 450 gp baseline
- **Khelziir's silver half-mask** — Vhaeraunian priestly regalia (Orvyn Tal: 200 gp; Lady Ulphor: 100 gp)
- **Spell scroll of Silence** (from Khelziir's pouch)
- **Potion of Greater Healing** × 2 (Vhaeraunian field stock)
- **Drow poison** × 4 vials (looted from Zeldrazz and the scouts)
- **The portal anchor** — 800 gp value to the Harpers if delivered intact (Ending 2); 400 gp to Lady Ulphor as evidence; 0 gp if smashed (+ public reputation); +500 gp Harper bounty if turned into a feed (Ending 3)
- **From Site B:** bone scroll case (50 gp), broken half-mask (40–80 gp), drow poison ×2, ~30 gp coin
- **Milestone:** Advance party to **Level 6** at session end

Loose Ends This Session Sets Up

- **Lolthite vs. Vhaeraunian war beneath Old Skull** is now confirmed and exploitable
- **Khelziir's superiors below** will retaliate — Session 3 candidate
- **Orvyn Tal / Harper recruitment** is now actionable depending on ending
- **Corwick Helm's cover-up** still unresolved — Lady Ulphor mentions: *"Captain Helm and I are speaking later this week."*
- **Zeldrazz T'orrl** — if he escapes a second time, he becomes a personal nemesis arc

DM Combat Tracker — The Second Cleft

Printable per-encounter sheets and stat-block cards. HP boxes = 5 HP each (cross out as damage is dealt). Spell-slot boxes = one per slot at that level.

Conditions reference: Bln · Chr · Deaf · Frt · Grp · Inc · Inv · Prl · Pet · Pzn · Prn · Rst · Stn · Uns · Conc

Encounter 1 — The Hawthorn Chimney — What Came Up After

Session 002, Scene 2 · **Hard for 5×L5 (~2,700 XP)**

Field	Detail
Location	Site B, Living Wood, Old Skull's southwestern flank
Light	Dim under hawthorn canopy; full dark inside chimney shaft
Terrain	Difficult terrain on hawthorn roots; chimney shaft = vertical 20 ft. climb

Round: ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 ☐6 ☐7 ☐8 ☐9 ☐10

Initiative & Damage

Init	Combatant	AC	HP	Notes
—	PC 1	—	_____	_____
—	PC 2	—	_____	_____
—	PC 3	—	_____	_____
—	PC 4	—	_____	_____
—	PC 5	—	_____	_____
12	Wounded Drider (Lolthite)	19	75 □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□	Starts <½ HP — strike top half of HP boxes
10	Giant Spider A (in shaft)	14	26 □□□□□□	Stays in shaft
10	Giant Spider B	14	26 □□□□□□	Drops on caster

Triggers & Countdowns

- Encounter starts when party investigates chimney shaft (or after ~3 in-fiction min if hesitating)
- Both giant spiders climb out on initiative count 10 of round 1
- Drider attempts retreat down shaft if reduced below ¼ HP

Concentration / Ongoing Effects

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Tactics Summary

- **Wounded Drider** — R1 Web on heaviest melee (likely Kto). Then close with obsidian dagger + bite. Retreats below ¼ HP.

- **Giant Spider A** — Advantage on attacks vs. anyone leaning into the shaft.
- **Giant Spider B** — Drops onto closest light-armored caster (Yinu or Loric).

Loot / Aftermath

Bone scroll case (intel — Lady Ulphor 50 gp) · Broken ceremonial half-mask (Orvyn 80 gp / Ulphor 40 gp) · Drow poison ×2 vials · ~30 gp coin

Notes (resources spent · persisting conditions · XP awarded)

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Encounter 2 — The Watcher Above

Session 002, Scene 3 · Trivial (skill encounter — stealth check, not protracted combat)

Field	Detail
Location	Cleft mouth, Site C, Old Skull's northern flank
Light	Late afternoon to dusk; deep shadow at the cleft mouth
Terrain	Watcher 60 ft. up a wind-stunted pine; cleft mouth below

Round: ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 ☐6 ☐7 ☐8 ☐9 ☐10

Initiative & Damage

Init	Combatant	AC	HP	Notes
—	PC 1	—	_____	_____
—	PC 2	—	_____	_____
—	PC 3	—	_____	_____
—	PC 4	—	_____	_____
—	PC 5	—	_____	_____
14	Drow Scout (Watcher)	15	13 ☐ ☐ ☐	Elevated cover

Triggers & Countdowns

- DC 17 Perception to spot her before she spots the party
- If she sees them first, she blows the brass signal horn on her turn
- If horn sounds → Khelziir's cell goes to alert; party loses surprise on Combat 3 antechamber

Concentration / Ongoing Effects

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Tactics Summary

- **Drow Scout (Watcher)** — Blow horn first. Then hand crossbow from elevation.

Loot / Aftermath

Brass signal horn (key item) · Hand crossbow + 10 bolts · Drow poison ×1 · ~5 gp

Notes (resources spent · persisting conditions · XP awarded)

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Encounter 3 — The Shrine — Khelziir's Last Ritual

Session 002, Scene 4 · Hard for 5×L5 (~4,400 XP). Becomes Deadly if the portal opens.

Field	Detail
Location	Chamber 3, Site C shrine-camp
Light	Black candles, greenish flames — dim throughout. Cookfire in antechamber.
Terrain	Three chambers. Shrine has 8-ft obsidian portal circle at center; basalt altar at back.

Round: ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 ☐6 ☐7 ☐8 ☐9 ☐10

Ritual Countdown (3 rounds):

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Initiative & Damage

Init	Combatant	AC	HP	Notes
—	PC 1	—	_____	_____
—	PC 2	—	_____	_____
—	PC 3	—	_____	_____
—	PC 4	—	_____	_____
—	PC 5	—	_____	_____
14	Zeldrazz T'orrl	18	71 □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□	Drow Elite Warrior reskin
13	Khelziir Aun'velve	16	78 □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□	Will not break formation from altar
11	Drow Scout (Antechamber A)	15	13 □□□	Fletching at start
11	Drow Scout (Antechamber B)	15	13 □□□	Dozing at start
10	Giant Spider (pen, optional)	14	26 □□□□□□□	Released only if chain cut
10	Vhaeraunian Drow ×4 (reinforcements)	15	13 ea □□□□□□□□□□□□	Only if countdown hits 0

Portal Anchor object:

Triggers & Countdowns

- **RITUAL COUNTDOWN: 3 rounds.** Stop = kill/KO Khelziir, full-round silence (he can step out — only delays), or destroy anchor (AC 12, 40 HP, vuln. bludgeoning).
- If countdown reaches 0: 4× Vhaeraunian drow step through on the next initiative.
- Chamber 2 spider shrieks alarm if silk curtain disturbed (audible throughout dungeon).
- If watcher's horn sounded: scouts ready, one sprints to the Shrine to warn Khelziir.

Concentration / Ongoing Effects

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Tactics Summary

- **Khelziir Aun'velve** — R1 spirit guardians + BA shield of faith. R2 silence on loudest caster. R3 spiritual weapon, continue ritual. R4+ portal opens.
- **Zeldrazz T'orrl** — Opens with poisoned attacks vs. PC who tried to kill him last session. Protective of Khelziir.
- **Drow Scout A** — Grabs crossbow, fights from cover. Dies R1 if surprised.
- **Drow Scout B** — Sprints to Shrine to warn Khelziir if not dropped R1.
- **Giant Spider (pen)** — Will not distinguish friend from foe.
- **Vhaeraunian Drow ×4** — Step through portal on next initiative. Standard Drow stat block (MM p.128).

Loot / Aftermath

Khelziir's silver half-mask (Orvyn 200 gp) · Spell scroll of Silence · Greater Healing potion ×2 · Drow poison ×4 vials · The portal anchor (ending-dependent)

Notes (resources spent · persisting conditions · XP awarded)

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Stat Cards

Reference cards for every non-PC combatant in the encounters above. Reprinted in full so the DM doesn't need to flip back during the fight.

Wounded Drider (Lolthite enforcer)

Large monstrosity, chaotic evil · CR 6 (2,300 XP)



Wounded Drider portrait

AC	HP	Speed
19 (natural armor)	75 (10d10+20)	30 ft., climb 30 ft.

STR 16 · DEX 16 · CON 18 · INT 13 · WIS 14 · CHA 12

Skills Perception +5, Stealth +9 · Senses darkvision 120 ft., passive Perception 15 · Languages Elvish, Undercommon

Traits

- Fey Ancestry — adv. on saves vs. charmed; can't be put to sleep magically.
- Spider Climb — climb difficult surfaces incl. ceilings without check.
- Sunlight Sensitivity — disadv. on attack rolls and Perception (sight) in sunlight.
- Web Walker — ignore movement restrictions from webbing.
- Innate Spellcasting (1/day each — strike when used): [] dancing lights · [] darkness · [] faerie fire.

Actions

- **Multiattack** — Longsword + Bite, OR Longbow ×2.

- **Bite** — +6 to hit, 1d4+3 piercing + 4d8 poison (DC 14 CON half).
- **Longsword** — +6 to hit, 1d8+3 (1d10+3 two-handed) slashing.
- **Longbow** — +6 to hit, 150/600 ft., 1d8+3 piercing + 2d8 poison (DC 14 CON half).
- **Web (Recharge 5-6)** — 30/60 ft., DC 13 DEX or restrained; AC 10, 5 HP, vuln. fire/slashing.

Tactics — R1 Web on heaviest melee. Close, multiattack. Below ¼ HP: retreat down chimney shaft. Will not surrender; will not negotiate.

Loot — Obsidian dagger (50 gp curio) · 2× Lolthite signal stones

Giant Spider

Large beast, unaligned · CR 1 (200 XP)

AC	HP	Speed
14 (natural armor)	26 (4d10+4)	30 ft., climb 30 ft.

STR 14 · DEX 16 · CON 12 · INT 2 · WIS 11 · CHA 4

Skills Stealth +7 · Senses blindsight 10 ft., darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 10 · MM p.328

Traits

- Spider Climb — including ceilings.
- Web Sense — knows location of anything in contact with the same web.
- Web Walker — ignores movement restrictions from webbing.

Actions

- **Bite** — +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., 1d8+3 piercing + 2d8 poison (DC 11 CON half; if reduced to 0 HP, stable but poisoned and paralyzed for 1 hr).
- **Web (Recharge 5-6)** — 30/60 ft. ranged, DC 11 DEX or restrained; AC 10, 5 HP, vuln. fire/slash.

Tactics — Drops on or webs the closest soft target. Pursues until killed.

Loot — —

Drow Scout

Medium humanoid (elf), neutral evil · CR 1/2 (100 XP)

AC	HP	Speed
15 (studded leather)	13 (3d8)	30 ft.

STR 10 · **DEX** 14 · **CON** 10 · **INT** 11 · **WIS** 13 · **CHA** 12

Skills Perception +5, Stealth +6, Survival +5 · Senses darkvision 120 ft., passive Perception 15 · Languages Elvish, Undercommon

Traits

- Fey Ancestry — adv. on saves vs. charmed; immune to magical sleep.
- Sunlight Sensitivity — disadv. on attack & Perception (sight) in sunlight.
- Innate Spellcasting (1/day each — strike when used): [] dancing lights · [] darkness · [] faerie fire.

Actions

- **Multiattack** — 2× shortsword OR 2× hand crossbow.
- **Shortsword** — +4 to hit, 1d6+2 piercing.
- **Hand Crossbow** — +4 to hit, 30/120 ft., 1d6+2 piercing + drow poison (DC 13 CON or unconscious 1 hr; ends if damaged).

Tactics — Crossbow from cover. Drops shortsword for stealth retreat if outmatched.

Loot — Hand crossbow · 10 bolts · Drow poison ×1 · 5 gp

Vhaeraunian Drow (reinforcement)

Medium humanoid (elf), neutral evil · CR 1/4 (50 XP)

AC	HP	Speed
15 (chain shirt)	13 (3d8)	30 ft.

STR 10 · **DEX** 14 · **CON** 10 · **INT** 11 · **WIS** 11 · **CHA** 12

Skills Perception +2, Stealth +4 · Senses darkvision 120 ft., passive Perception 12 · Standard Drow, MM p.128

Traits

- Fey Ancestry, Sunlight Sensitivity, Innate Spellcasting (1/day each: dancing lights, darkness, faerie fire).

Actions

- **Shortsword** — +4 to hit, 1d6+2 piercing.
- **Hand Crossbow** — +4 to hit, 30/120 ft., 1d6+2 + drow poison (DC 13 CON or unconscious 1 hr).

Tactics — Step through the portal. Form a line in front of Khelziir. Fight to the death.

Loot — Standard Drow loadout (deconstruct ×4)

Khelziir Aun'velve — Drow Priest of Vhaeraun

Medium humanoid (drow), neutral evil · CR 6 (2,300 XP)



Khelziir Aun'velve portrait

AC	HP	Speed
16 (chain shirt + shield of faith)	78 (12d8+24)	30 ft.

STR 11 · DEX 14 · CON 14 · INT 13 · WIS 17 · CHA 14

Saves WIS +6, CHA +5 · Skills Perception +6, Religion +4, Stealth +5 · Senses darkvision 120 ft., passive Perception 16
· Languages Common, Elvish, Undercommon

Traits

- Fey Ancestry, Sunlight Sensitivity.
- Innate Spellcasting (1/day each — strike when used): [] faerie fire · [] darkness · [] levitate.

Spellcasting (cleric, save DC 14, +6 to hit)

- Cantrips: guidance, sacred flame, thaumaturgy
- 1st ([] [] [] []): bane, command, shield of faith
- 2nd ([] [] []): silence, spiritual weapon
- 3rd ([] [] []): dispel magic, spirit guardians
- 4th ([]): banishment

Actions

- **Multiattack** — 2× shortsword.
- **Shortsword** — +5 to hit, 1d6+2 piercing + 1d6 poison.

- **Hand Crossbow** — +5 to hit, 30/120 ft., 1d6+2 + drow poison (DC 13 CON or unconscious 1 hr).

Tactics — R1 spirit guardians + BA shield of faith. R2 silence on loudest caster. R3 spiritual weapon, continue ritual. R4+ portal opens. Will not leave altar.

Loot — Silver half-mask (200 gp) · Spell scroll of Silence · 2× Greater Healing potions

Zeldrazz T'orrl — Drow Elite Warrior (reskinned)

Medium humanoid (drow), neutral evil · CR 5 (1,800 XP)



Zeldrazz T'orrl portrait

AC	HP	Speed
18 (chain shirt + shield)	71 (13d8+13)	30 ft.

STR 14 · **DEX** 18 · **CON** 13 · **INT** 11 · **WIS** 13 · **CHA** 12

Saves DEX +7, CON +4, WIS +4 · Skills Perception +4, Stealth +7 · Senses darkvision 120 ft., passive Perception 14 · MM p.128

Traits

- Fey Ancestry, Sunlight Sensitivity.
- Innate Spellcasting (1/day each — strike when used): [] dancing lights · [] darkness · [] faerie fire · [] levitate.

Actions

- **Multiattack** — 2× shortsword (one as bonus action — see below).
- **Shortsword** — +7 to hit, 1d6+4 piercing + 3d6 poison (DC 13 CON half) + 2d6 poison (DC 13 CON or poisoned 1 min, retry each end of turn).
- **Hand Crossbow** — +7 to hit, 30/120 ft., 1d6+4 + drow poison (DC 13 CON or unconscious 1 hr).

Reactions

- **Parry** — +3 AC vs. one melee attack he can see, must be wielding a melee weapon.

Tactics — Opens with poisoned attacks vs. PC who tried to kill him last session (carries the grudge openly). Protective of Khelziir — will interpose.

Loot — Plain steel scimitar · 2× drow poison vials · cracked half-mask trophy

Player Handouts — The Second Cleft

One image per entry. Show these at the table when the party encounters the person, monster, or location depicted. Maps may be revealed in sections at GM discretion.

Brynn Ashford — Shadowdale's Delegate to the Dales Council



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Corwick Helm — Blacksmith and Militia Captain



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Khelziir Aun'velve — Drow Priest of Vhaeraun



Khelziir Aun'velve — Drow Priest of Vhaeraun

Zeldrazz T'orrl — Drow Elite Warrior, Demoted



Zeldrazz T'orrl — Drow Elite Warrior, Demoted

The Wounded Drider — Lolthite Enforcer at Site B



The Wounded Drider — Lolthite Enforcer at Site B

The Hawthorn Chimney — Site B Approach



The Hawthorn Chimney — Site B Approach

The Cleft Mouth — Site C Entrance



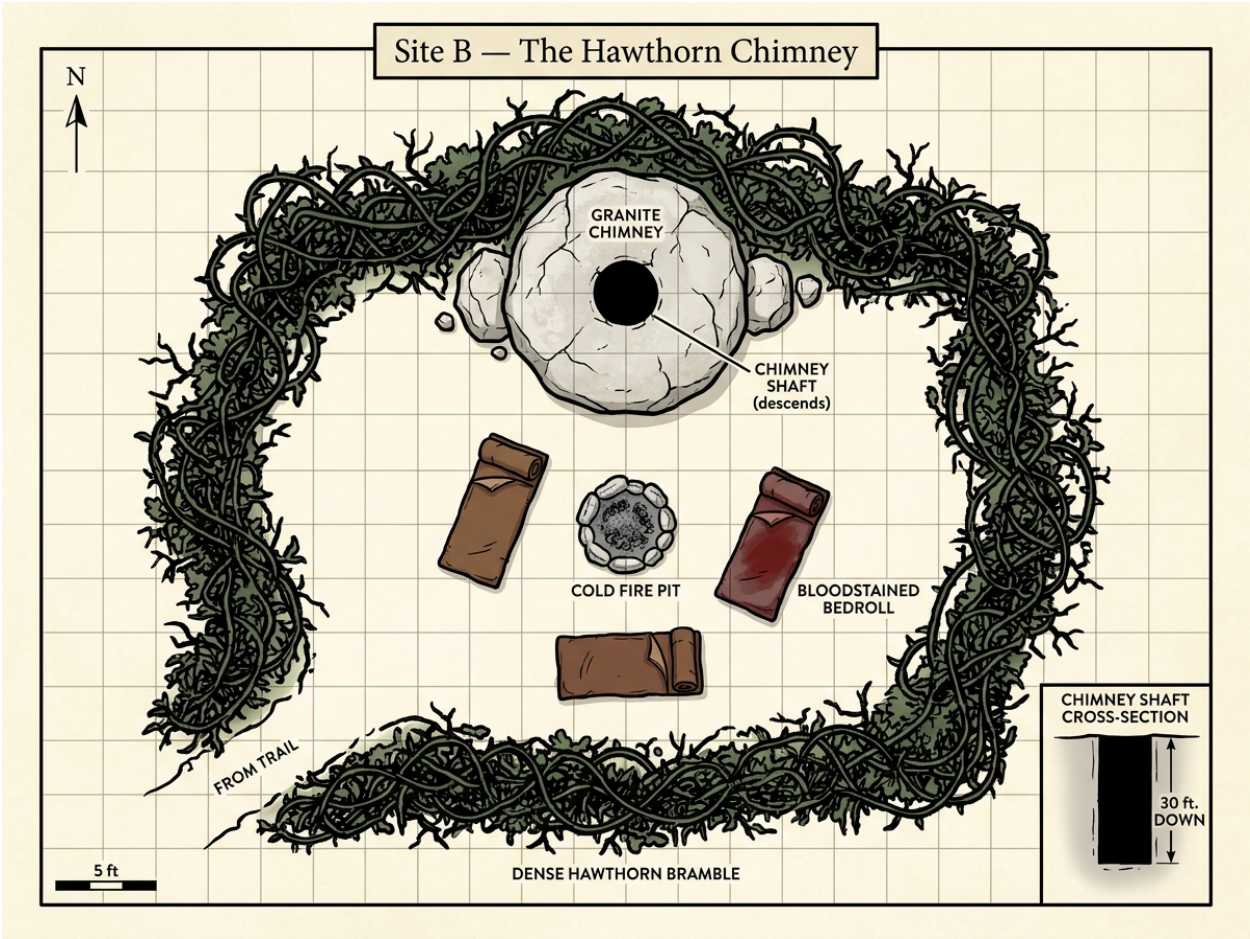
The Cleft Mouth — Site C Entrance

The Shrine Chamber — Site C Interior



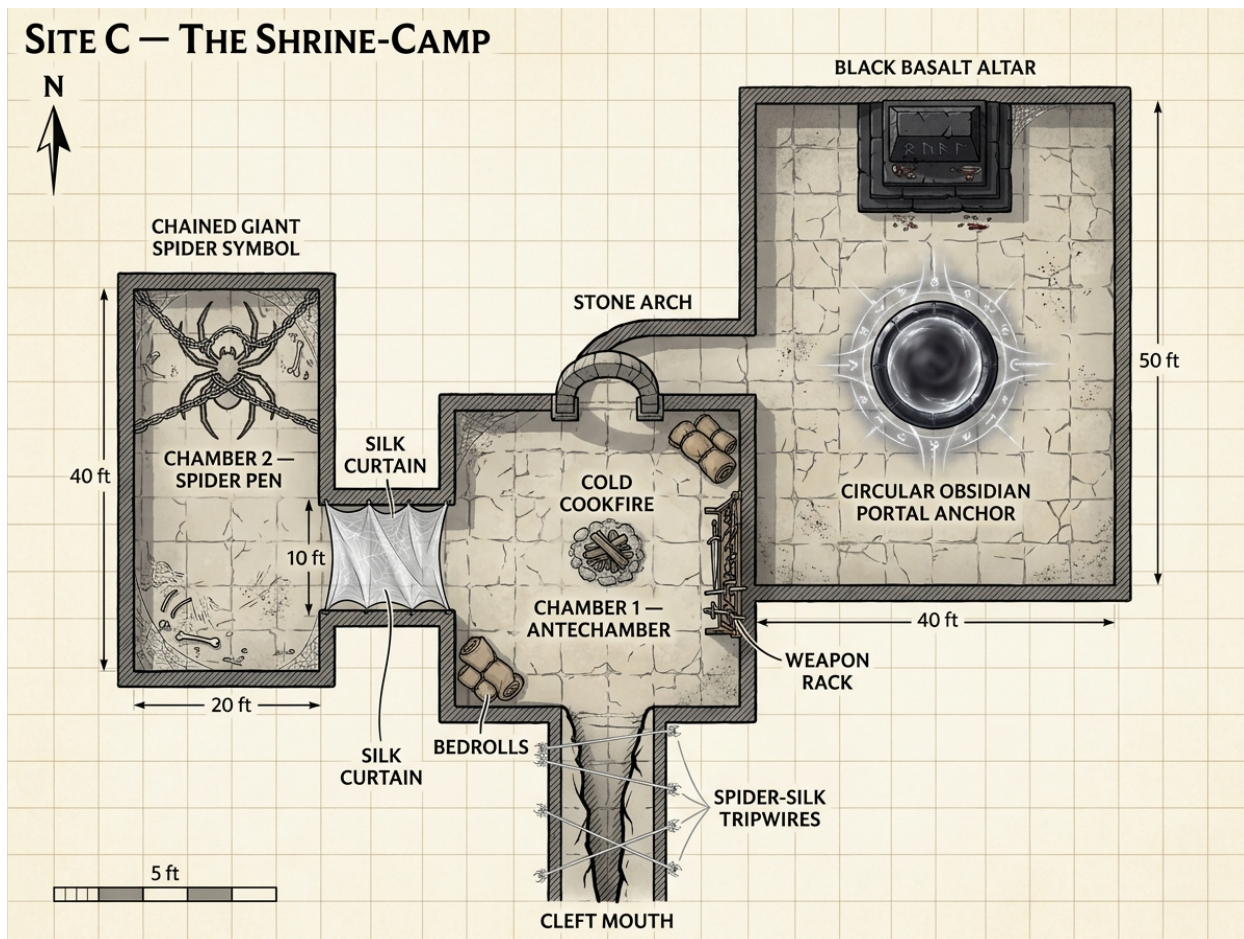
The Shrine Chamber — Site C Interior

Tactical Map — Site B, The Hawthorn Chimney



Tactical Map — Site B, The Hawthorn Chimney

Tactical Map — Site C, The Shrine-Camp



Tactical Map — Site C, The Shrine-Camp